

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)
Regional Office for Eastern Africa**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Nairobi, Kenya
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Natural Sciences

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Mr. Christian Berretta
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Project Officer - Science

3. Background information

UNESCO, the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, is a specialized agency dedicated to strengthening our shared humanity through the promotion of education, science, culture, and communication.

We set standards, produce tools and develop knowledge to create solutions to some of the greatest challenges of our time, and foster a world of greater equality and peace.

Established in 1965, the UNESCO Regional Office for Eastern Africa in Nairobi supports 13 countries: Comoros, Djibouti, Ethiopia, Eritrea, Kenya, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda, Seychelles, Somalia, South Sudan, United Republic of Tanzania, and Uganda.

The mission of UNESCO Nairobi in the Region is to support Member States in strengthening education and training systems to provide high quality, equitable and inclusive education and training for all and

equip children, young people and adults with skills for life and work, values and attitudes to build secure, resilient and sustainable societies.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Under the overall supervision of the Director and Representative of the UNESCO Regional Office for Eastern Africa in Nairobi, and the direct supervision of the Science Programme Specialist, the Fellow will assist in the implementation of Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP) and additionally assist in activities related to Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) and the Man and Biosphere (MAB) Programme. In particular, the trainee will:

- Learn and provide technical advice and support to Member States towards the implementation of the above programmes, including related activities and projects.
- Coordinates and supports the collection and compilation of data to support reporting.
- Conducts research to collect data and information to be used in the development of project proposals
- Supports the coordination and communication with partners nationally and regionally.
- Participates in the organization and follow-up of meetings, consultations and conferences, the production of required materials and the provision of information and assistance to partners.
- Assist in drafting and preparation of press releases, presentations, speeches, briefing notes, graph material and publications.
- Provide general office assistance to the Natural Science team.
- Carry out any other duty considered relevant to the experience the trainee needs to acquire.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree in Hydrology / Environmental Management, Environmental Sciences / Engineering / Ecology or other fields relevant to Natural Resources Management.

Work experience

Preferably a minimum of one year of professional experience in the Hydrology, Geography, Climatology, Disaster Risk Reduction or Management, Natural Resources Management, Environmental Management and related fields.

- Experience in project management as well as development and implementation of programmes
- Experience in the support and/or coordination of medium to large-scale events is an asset

Languages

Fluency in written and spoken English is essential. Working knowledge of another UN language, preferably French, would be an asset.

Other skills

- **Teamwork:** Works effectively with and supports colleagues, fostering a positive and collaborative environment.
- **Results focus:** Focuses on and assumes accountability for the delivery of agreed results, and demonstrates an understanding of how these contribute to the goals of UNESCO.
- **Accountability:** Operates in compliance with UNESCO's rules and fulfills all commitments made to colleagues and partners.
- **Communication:** Effectively conveys and shares information and ideas with others, listening carefully, clarifying understanding and taking into consideration different viewpoints.
- **IT skills:** Fully proficient computer skills in Microsoft Office applications. Design and editing skills are desirable.

Competencies

Core values: Integrity, Professionalism and Respect for Diversity

Core competencies:

- Communication: ability to communicate clearly and request clarification when needed
- Accountability: drive for results, demonstrate responsibility, rectify mistakes
- Teamwork: ability to function and interact with team members and across the office

6. Learning Elements

The Fellow will have an interdisciplinary character and include the following learning elements:

- Experience of working in the field office in UN system.
- In-depth knowledge of global agendas such as SDG, Sendai Framework of Action, Paris Climate Change Agreement, and Africa Agenda 2063.
- Opportunity to contribute to the development of the policy and strategy for Eastern Africa countries.
- Networking with African stakeholders.
- Capacity development for document drafting.
- Improvement in monitor, evaluation, communication and negotiation skills.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

To ensure a successful traineeship experience, UNESCO would provide support to the trainee with a comprehensive onboarding package that includes an overview of its mission, structure, and key programmes/subject areas, particularly in Hydrology, Geography, Climatology, Disaster Risk Reduction or Management, Natural Resources Management, Environmental Management and related fields.

Access to relevant background documents, strategic plans, and relevant information that would help the trainee understand the context and priorities of the Nairobi Office. Practical resources such as training on internal tools, a calendar of upcoming events, and guidance on local customs and office protocols would ease integration. Additionally, a clear supervision and mentorship plan, along with opportunities for learning and development, would enhance the intern's engagement and professional growth throughout the assignment.

The Supervisor will also organize separate introduction meetings with other sectors (Education, Social and Human Sciences, Culture, Communication and Information) for the trainee to be introduced to other sectors and have a brief overview of the work of the different sectors, to facilitate opportunities for intersectorality.

Weekly Meetings of the SC Unit: The incumbent will attend and participate in the weekly meetings of the Sector, chaired by the Head of Unit/Programme Specialist, to plan and review the Sector's activities, and where the Supervisee will be expected to also report on activities/tasks assigned to her/him, as appropriate, for better coordination and synergies.

All Office Staff Meeting: The Supervisee will be expected to participate in monthly staff meetings of the Regional Office during which she/he could be requested to share contributions/insights/presentations of the SC Sector, as may be needed.

8. Living conditions in the country

Nairobi, the capital of Kenya, is a major political, economic, and cultural hub in Eastern Africa, hosting numerous United Nations agencies, international organizations, and diplomatic missions. The city offers a wide range of housing, education, and healthcare options, as well as reliable internet and communication infrastructure. While living costs vary depending on location and lifestyle, adequate accommodation and essential services are readily available. Nairobi has a moderate climate throughout

the year and offers rich cultural and recreational opportunities, although usual precautions related to urban safety are advised.

Nairobi hosts the UN HQ for Africa – UNON – as well as other NGOs i.e. IRC, VSO, Save the Children; and private sectors regional HQ such as Google, Microsoft and include expats from both public and private sectors, but also host the largest slum in Africa